

two-wheeler giant, Ather Energy has raised \$128 million in a Series E round of funding. The funds will be used to expand manufacturing facilities, research and development, charging infrastructure, and retail network growth. There are 100 odd suppliers who provide customised components as the scooter has been built from scratch. The founder says they will support these suppliers so that they can ramp up production to 60,000-70,000 a month.

## Toyota planning to make EV parts in Karnataka

Looking to develop electric vehicle (EV) parts in India, automaker Toyota group firms are planning to invest about ₹48 billion in Karnataka for local production of powertrain parts and other components of electric vehicles. They plan to utilise their existing facilities in the state. A memorandum of understanding (MoU) has been signed with the Karnataka government in this regard. While TKM and Toyota Kirloskar Auto Parts (TKAP) will invest ₹41 billion, Toyota Industries Engine India will pitch in with another ₹7 billion. The Toyota group companies have already invested ₹118.12 billion in the country and employ more than 8000 people at present.

## HOP Electric raises \$2.6 million as part of \$10 million fundraiser

Growing at an MoM rate of 50%, HOP Electric Mobility has closed a strategic round of \$2.6 million as part of an ongoing \$10 million pre-series fundraising. The EV maker is targeting a 10x growth in 2022. HOP Electric Mobility, a diversified business venture of Rays Power Infra, is one of the three new non-automotive investors to qualify under the production linked incentive scheme for OEMs earlier this year. It has also embarked on its multi-battery modular platform's design and engineering journey developing Gen 2 smart batteries and swapping stations.

## BEL to manufacture battery packs for Triton electric trucks

An MoU has been signed between Triton and the Gujarat State Government for setting up an iconic EV truck manufacturing plant with a commitment to invest around Rs 108 billion over a span of five years. Li-ion battery packs would be manufactured by the Pune unit of Navratna Defence PSU Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL). The partnership between BEL and Triton is set to give a major boost to the *Atmanirbhar Bharat* initiative.

## Ford calls off EV manufacturing plans in India

Shortlisted among the twenty automakers under the Champion OEM scheme, Ford's plans to manufacture electric vehicles in India have now been called off. Last year, Ford India had announced the shutdown of its manufacturing units at Maraimalai Nagar in Tamil Nadu and Sanand in Gujarat. The decision of Ford to opt out of EV production in India has cast doubt on the future of workers at the company's now-shut Chennai plant. Tamil Nadu was betting big on EVs, with the state even extending its talks with players like Tesla. Approximately 4000 employees are expected to be affected by this.

## IIT-M incubated EV sub-component manufacturing startup raises funds

IIT Madras (IIT-M) based electric vehicle (EV) sub-component manufacturing startup, Revoh Innovations Private Ltd, has raised \$150,000 in a seed round from angel investors Vel Kannianappan and Ravi Renganathan. Revoh's R&D division will continue to function from the IIT-M Research Park. Incorporated a couple of years ago by a group of electronics engineering graduates, Revoh's primary goal is to localise the electric vehicle sub-components' manufacturing and eventually reduce country's dependence on foreign manufacturers. It has also exported the BLDC controllers to clients in the UK and Netherlands.

## Tata group may enter the battery business soon

Tata Group is preparing the blueprint to launch a battery company as part of its transition to be future-ready. Tata group is keen to see electric vehicle ecosystem growth in the country. While the existing business is undergoing transformation, the group has also entered new areas, like the Tata Neu super app, to prepare itself for an omni-channel consumer-facing ecosystem and the launch of a very large scale precision manufacturing electronics company, which has global aspirations.

## Switch Mobility to develop EV range in the UK and India

Switch Mobility is planning to develop a range of electric vehicles that would create over 4000 skilled jobs in the UK and India. The UK venue is expected to start operation in June 2022 and will work closely with the company's existing R&D offices in Chennai, Leeds, and Valladolid employing a further 200 engineers.

## Sun Mobility and Greaves Electric Mobility sign MoU for swappable EV batteries

As part of an MoU agreement, Greaves Electric Mobility (GEM) and Sun Mobility will deploy swappable batteries for electric vehicles in the country. With Sun Mobility's battery technology, GEM aims to use the infrastructure and battery for both electric two-wheelers and three-wheelers. Through this venture, GEM also aims to enhance the EV ecosystem by offering an array of multibrand smart mobility commuting.

## Garuda Aerospace raises pre Series A funding for drones

Garuda Aerospace has raised an undisclosed sum as pre Series A funding from investors led by Ocgrow Ventures. The drone manufacturer and drone-as-a-service provider will ship out about 4000 drones to African countries. This investment round would serve more so as a primer before the startup's larger \$30 million series A round scheduled in June 2022. Garuda is also the lowest bidder in the RITES Ltd tender for lidar based survey.

## IdeaForge raises Series B funding for drones

Drone manufacturer IdeaForge has raised \$20 million in a Series B funding round led by Florintree. The round also saw participation from the company's existing investors Celesta (a prominent technology investment fund), Infosys, Qualcomm, and Infina, along with the Exim Bank of India. Founded in 2007 by IIT Bombay alumni, IdeaForge has over fifteen years of R&D history and it owns more than 20 global patents.

## Rays Power Infra sells its solar projects to global investors

Solar PV cell maker Rays Power Infra has sold its solar projects in Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, and Telangana to two global investors for over ₹7 billion. These projects had accumulated debt worth approximately ₹4 billion and had EBITDA of ₹950 million. The transactions have enabled the company to raise enough capital to support its future growth. Rays Power Infra has already completed more than 1GW of project commissioning and asset sale.

## IIT-P signs MoU with IoT startup Redinent for R&D and innovation

Indian Institute of Technology Patna (IIT-P) has signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with Bangalore based IoT cybersecurity startup Redinent for research, development, and innovation in IoT and cybersecurity products. The MoU signing function was attended by senior officers from both sides.